SkillNavora

HANDBOOK 7

12-month SFMC learning roadmap

Seven stages with study time, milestones and assessments.

Salesforce Marketing Cloud (SFMC) Academy. Verify product names, editions, licences and certifications on Salesforce's official pages.

Varun Kumar · SkillNavora · skillnavora.in
Edition: November 2026. Practice labs marked "account" need a provisioned Marketing Cloud account. Other labs use sample files or paper.

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12-month learning roadmap

A realistic plan for a beginner studying part time. Adjust the hours to your time. The programme makes no promise of employment or any salary.

Stage	Topics	Study time	Practical milestone	Assessment
Stage 1 · Months 1 to 2	CRM and marketing fundamentals, Salesforce ecosystem, SFMC basics (Modules 1 to 3)	About 8 hours a week	Lifecycle map, metrics calculations, business unit design	Explain the lifecycle and metrics in an interview-style answer
Stage 2 · Months 3 to 4	Contacts, data architecture, data extensions, import and cleaning (Modules 4 and 5)	About 10 hours a week	Customer data extension with keys and a clean import	Import a file with planted duplicates and fix it
Stage 3 · Months 5 to 6	SQL for SFMC, HTML and CSS, JavaScript basics, AMPscript (Modules 6, 9 and 10)	About 12 hours a week	Ten SQL queries, a responsive email, ten AMPscript personalisations	Code review and a timed SQL test
Stage 4 · Months 7 to 8	Email Studio, Content Builder, Journey Builder, Automation Studio (Modules 7, 8, 11 and 12)	About 12 hours a week	Welcome journey, abandoned cart journey, scheduled automation	Journey and automation walkthrough
Stage 5 · Months 9 to 10	CloudPages, Mobile Studio, personalisation, analytics, APIs and integrations (Modules 13 to 18)	About 12 hours a week	CloudPage form, REST integration, API-triggered email	API demo with Postman and error handling
Stage 6 · Month 11	Data Cloud, advanced automation, security, deliverability, testing and architecture (Modules 19 to 23)	About 10 hours a week	Architecture document and a troubleshooting report	Architecture presentation and scenario answers
Stage 7 · Month 12	AI in marketing, capstone projects, portfolio, interviews and certification planning (Modules 24, 26 to 28)	About 15 hours a week	Two capstone projects published with demo videos	Three mock interviews and a certification plan